Alternative Pathway to Initial Licensure in a World Language or ESL
Practicum Requirements Corresponding to 5-6 Credits

Each practicum experience requires the following:

1. Course registration for CI 5696, 5697 and/or 5698: Candidates must register for CI 5696 (elementary world language practicum), 5697 (elementary ESL practicum) or 5698 (secondary practicum for either world language or ESL) during the semester in which they plan to complete the practicum experience. **They must register for the number of credits that the contract stipulates.** It is possible to register for both practicum experiences in one semester if placements are available and if the candidate has the time needed to complete requirements for both in one semester.

2. Pre-practicum observation: Candidates observe the cooperating teacher for a minimum of 10 hours. In some cases, observation may include viewing recommended videotapes of language classroom teaching.

3. Classroom teaching: Candidates conduct a minimum of 80 hours of classroom practice (actual contact hours with students). The length of the practicum is negotiated with SLC staff, the cooperating teacher, and the candidate. However, each practicum typically involves at least eight continuous weeks of classroom teaching and observation. Longer time frames (up to 15 weeks in a semester) are recommended.

4. In-depth reflection: Candidates engage in some in-depth written reflection throughout the observation and teaching experience. The reflection can be in the form of a journal of about 15-20 pages, or, when available, can occur via interaction on a blog that is organized by the assigned university supervisor. This is an opportunity for candidates to contemplate and set some short- and long-term professional goals. Candidates submit the journal at the end of the placement to their assigned university supervisor or interact via the blog throughout the placement.

5. Video reflection assignment: Candidates are required to videotape one of their lessons, watch it and later reflect in writing on the video. They are responsible for obtaining cameras or recorders (most schools have them, as does the C&I Curriculum Library), and organizing the recording process. When recording, candidates may also want to audio record the same session, as the audio tracks on video cameras frequently do not record large-group events well. Candidates should make every attempt to set up the video camera on a tripod somewhere in the classroom so that both the teacher and the students (at least some of them) are in view. Candidates may also ask another adult in the classroom or school to operate the camera. It is advisable to test the equipment to make sure it is working properly.

- Candidates should record an entire class period. They are expected to independently view the video of their teaching and prepare a written reflection of 8-10 pages (typed, double-spaced). The written reflection should focus on some of the following aspects:

    - an evaluation of what happened—e.g., based on the lesson plan you developed, were your objectives met? What might you have done differently and why?
    - alternative responses to classroom interactions—e.g., how might you have elicited more student language use?
    - discussion and analysis of things that were revealed by the recording—e.g., what activities seemed to work well? What didn't work well? How was the discourse shared in the lesson? How much did you talk? How much did students talk? Was there student-to-student interaction? If not, how might that be planned for? What language were students exposed to in the lesson (input)? What language were they able to practice (output)? What impression of the target language culture would students get from the lesson?

6. Group meeting to share excerpts of videos and give and receive feedback: Candidates are required to bring the videotape of the lesson to a group meeting on campus as a stimulus for discussion and peer feedback. The university supervisor will contact all candidates engaged in student teaching experiences in a given semester to schedule a group meeting. When candidates present the video to the group, they should select 10-15 minutes of the recording to share. They should prepare a short description of the context and lesson that can be shared with the group. They should also plan to take notes on feedback that is offered.
7. Scheduled visit(s) with university supervisor: Candidates arrange via email or phone with the assigned university supervisor a date/time for supervised visits. At least three visits with the university supervisor are required. More may be arranged on a case by case basis. The candidate is required to provide the supervisor with a copy of the lesson plan the days s/he visits.